The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue XIV in F-sharp minor, five voices: Ricercar a 5 sopra il Thema Regio

Piano (five voices)

Claude / Sam (on Frederick the Great's Royal Theme, after J. S. Bach's Musical Offering, BWV 1079)

Exordium: the King's theme

Alla breve, grave e poi animato (♩ = 84)

Cantus

Altus

Tenor

Quintus

Bassus

Thema Regium

9

C

A

T

Q

B

contrasubiectum I "Ascensus"

Thema Regium: risposta (tonal answer)

contrasubiectum I

Thema Regium (bassus)

Canon per augmentationem et contrario motu

Thema Regium: dux of the canon per augmentationem et contrario motu

18

C

A

T

Q

B

contrasubiectum II "Descensus"


Quintus: the answer
26
C
A
T
Q
B
Thema Regium: risposta (the fifth voice)
canon per augmentationem et contrario motu: comes (inversus per augmentationem)
Canon per tonos: C minor
C#7 = G7: to C minor
40
canon per tonos 1 (C minor, the King's key): dux, thema per diminutionem
canon per tonos 1 (C minor, the King's key): comes at the octave
D minor
48
canon per tonos 2 (D minor): dux, thema per diminutionem
canon per tonos 2 (D minor): comes at the octave


E minor
canon per tonos 3 (E minor): dux, thema per diminutionem
55
C
A
T
Q
B
canon per tonos 3 (E minor): comes at the octave
Summit: F-sharp minor, theme in augmentation
canon per tonos, the fourth step: home in F-sharp minor (dux, per diminutionem)
62
canon per tonos, the fourth step: comes at the octave
Thema Regium per augmentationem (bassus): "Notulis crescentibus crescat Fortuna Regis"
Inversion to F#6
inversus per diminutionem, rising to F#6
70
Cadence